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What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **China's GDP**, as a share of the global economy, peaked in 2021 at about 19%, but it declined to about 17% in 2025, less than two-thirds the size of the U.S. economy, according to IMF data. **A1**

◆ **A California jury** found Elon Musk liable for some losses Twitter investors experienced after he threatened to walk away from the \$44 billion acquisition of the social-media company in 2022. But the jury absolved him of "engaging in a scheme to defraud Twitter investors." **B9**

◆ **CBS News is ending** its radio service as part of broader layoffs while Editor in Chief Bari Weiss looks to reshape the storied network. **B9**

◆ **Investors' hopes** for a quick resolution to the Iran war are fading. All three major indexes fell for a fourth-straight week. The yield on the 10-year Treasury note climbed to 4.39%, its highest level since July. Brent crude futures climbed to \$112.19 a barrel. **B10**

◆ **Super Micro Computer** co-founder Yih-Shyan Liaw has resigned as a director after being indicted for his alleged role smuggling high-end Nvidia chips to China. **B9**

◆ **Novartis struck a deal** valued at up to \$3 billion to buy an experimental breast-cancer drug from Synnovion. **B9**

Worldwide

◆ **Iran's regime is signaling** that it believes it is winning the war and has the power to impose a settlement on Washington that entrenches Tehran's dominance of Middle East energy resources for decades to come. **A1, A5-7**

◆ **The war has triggered** the broadest and fastest wave of attacks against U.S. embassies and consulates in the post-9/11 era. **A5**

◆ **President Trump** is seeking to lower the profile of his mass deportation effort, according to people familiar with the matter. **A1**

◆ **Some Democrats** are discussing how to get Sen. Chuck Schumer to step aside as minority leader. **A1**

◆ **States, towns and organizations** are racing to strip Cesar Chavez's name off buildings, boulevards, parks and parades after allegations he abused women and girls. **A3**

◆ **The Trump administration** is suing Harvard, alleging the university violated Jewish students' civil rights. **A3**

◆ **A federal judge** blocked the administration from enforcing a policy that limits reporters' access to the Pentagon. **A2**

◆ **U.S. authorities** are investigating whether drug money was used to fund the Colombian president's campaign. **A8**

Died: Chuck Norris, action-movie and TV star, 86. **A3**

OPINION

An ally's guide to understanding Donald Trump **A11**

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Tehran's Airstrikes Prove Persistent



NO SHELTER: An Israeli family crouches on the road from Tel Aviv to Jerusalem, as sirens warn of an incoming Iranian missile. The U.S. is racing to ship air defenses to the Gulf, and the war has sparked attacks on American diplomatic missions. **A5**

Iran Sees an Opening to Control Mideast Energy Over Long Run

By YAROSLAV TROFIMOV

DUBAI—Three weeks into the war, Iran's regime is signaling that it believes it is winning and has the power to impose a settlement on Washington that entrenches Tehran's dominance of Middle East energy resources for decades to come. This attitude might prove to be a dangerous misreading

of President Trump's determination, or of Israel's capacity to inflict blows on the Islamic Republic's surviving leadership and military capabilities. Trump and Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu of Israel have given mixed signals on how long the war would go on, as they try to talk markets down and keep Tehran guessing. Netanyahu said Thursday

the war would end "a lot faster than people think." Trump said Friday the U.S. is considering "winding down" its military operation in Iran, even as the Pentagon sent thousands of additional Marines to the region. The problem is, Iran also has a say in when the guns fall silent—and, for now, it seems to think time works to its benefit.

Despite optimistic U.S. and Israeli pronouncements about destroying launchers and missile stocks, Iran has retained

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- ◆ **U.S. rushes air defenses to the Gulf**..... **A5**
- ◆ **South Pars gas field attack strikes at Iran lifeline**..... **A6**
- ◆ **U.S. energy sector gets boost from crisis**..... **A7**

Beijing's Big Problem: A Shrinking Economy

By JON EMONT

By most standards, China's economy has never been stronger. Its exporters have powered the country to a \$1.2 trillion surplus with the world. It is the global leader in strategically important industries such as electric vehicles, solar panels, shipbuilding and humanoid robots. Yet, by one important measure, China's global heft is shrinking. In dollar terms, China's gross domestic product, as a share of the global economy, peaked in 2021 at around 19%, when it grew to be around three quarters of the size of the U.S. economy. Many economists predicted

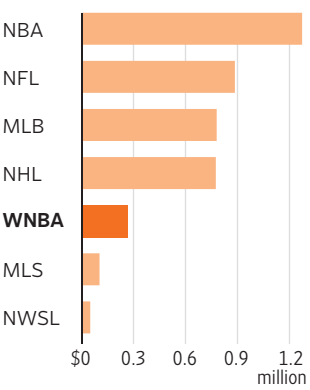
China's growth would eventually make its economy bigger than that of the U.S. Instead China's share of the pie has decreased, ending 2025 at around 17% of the global economy. It is now less than two-thirds the size of the U.S. economy, according to International Monetary Fund data. Beijing continues to post growth figures that easily exceed developed countries. Although China's government has projected lower growth for 2026 than any year since the early 1990s, it still expects to grow at 4.5-5% in real terms, double the typical rate of the U.S. over the past decade. But a combination of do-

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WNBA Scores 364% Raise

It's biggest jump ever seen in U.S. professional sports. **A10**

Minimum salary across major North American sports leagues



Note: NFL, MLB, WNBA, NWSL, MLS for 2026 season; NBA, NHL for 2025-26 season
Sources: Spotrac; the leagues

Democrats' Frustration With Schumer Grows

Sen. Chris Murphy was dining with progressive activists at a French restaurant in Georgetown when the conversation about how to advance

By Siobhan Hughes, Eliza Collins and Tarini Parti

their legislative priorities turned to a thorny question: what to do about Senate Minority Leader Chuck Schumer. To the surprise of some attendees, the Connecticut Democrat—a rising star in the party's left flank—responded that some lawmakers had been doing informal counts to see whether enough votes existed to remove the New York Demo-

crat from his leadership position, according to people familiar with the mid-February dinner. Murphy explained that Schumer had enough backing to remain the leader. But the disclosure stood out because it revealed that frustration inside the Senate had reached a high enough level that some Democrats were actively contemplating how to oust Schumer. Murphy is among a group of senators and top advisers who have grown increasingly dissatisfied with Schumer's leadership, according to people familiar with the conversations. That group includes Sen. Elizabeth Warren of Massachusetts, who has been initiating con-

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EXCHANGE



THE CODE WARS
The trillion-dollar race to automate our entire lives. **B1**

One of the Hottest Tables In America Is a College Dining Hall

Meals are so good at UMass Amherst locals add its cafeterias to date-night rotations

By JASMINE LI

AMHERST, Mass.—When Lisa Yee's son brought his girlfriend home over the winter, the children's book author knew the perfect place for a family meal. It featured flavors from all corners of the world, made by award-winning chefs from locally sourced ingredients. "You'll love it," Yee told them. "It's a dining hall." The cafeterias at the University of Massachusetts Amherst

joined Yee's date-night rotation when her husband took a job there as an adjunct professor. On the faculty dining plan, he pays \$13.25 a meal. "One of us will say, 'Wait a minute, we haven't gone to the dining hall in a while. Let's go there,'" she said. "And we both get really excited." For nine years, UMass Amherst has been ranked No. 1 for campus food in the country, according to annual surveys of more than

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AI Companies Pour Money Into Midterms

Groups opposed to strict AI regulations target New York congressional candidate

By MAGGIE SEVERNS AND AMRITH RAMKUMAR

More than 100 people crowded into a bar on a chilly Saturday evening on Manhattan's west side to draw up battle plans for a brewing national showdown over artificial-intelligence policy. Their leader is Alex Bores, a 35-year-old computer scientist and New York state assemblyman who is running to represent a congressional district that covers much of Manhattan. Until recently, he

was considered a long shot in a June Democratic primary with a dozen candidates, including anti-Trump lawyer George Conway and Jack Schlossberg, grandson of John F. Kennedy. That was before a big AI political-action committee decided to spend millions of dollars opposing him. Now, Bores's dad regularly receives negative fliers about him in his mailbox. Neighbors ask him in the elevator about anti-Bores texts they've re-

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